SHEET A • AGES 6–10 • 25 MINUTES

# Elementary: What makes a home?

**Purpose:** Help children understand that people need more than walls and a roof ... they need safety, stability, connection, and dignity.

**Facilitator opening:** “People live in different kinds of homes. Some families have to move often, and some people do not have a stable place to stay. No one should be teased or judged because of where they live.”

## 1. Draw a place that helps someone feel safe (10 minutes)

Inside the box, draw or write three things that help a person feel safe and cared for.

## 2. Talk together (10 minutes)

- Which of these things does everyone need?
- How would you feel if you had to move and did not know where you would sleep?
- What can you do to make someone feel welcome and respected?

## 3. One kind action (5 minutes)

This week I can show kindness by: _____

**Host note:** Keep examples gentle, do not ask about children’s personal housing situations, and allow anyone to skip sharing.

SHEET B • AGES 11–13 • 30–35 MINUTES

# Middle grades: Everyday needs map

**Purpose:** Understand how stable housing makes ordinary routines easier ... and how communities can reduce barriers.

## 1. Choose three everyday needs

Circle three: **Sleep | Toilets | Food | Phone charging | Laundry | Transportation | Shower | Storage | School supplies | Quiet place to study**

## 2. Fill in the chart (15 minutes)

| NEED | When a person has a stable home ... | What may become difficult without one? |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

## 3. Name a community response (10 minutes)

Pick one difficulty. What organization, public facility, friend, service, or housing option might reduce it?

**Discuss:** Why might it be difficult to keep a job or attend school when basic routines become unpredictable? Do not assume a participant's housing situation.

SHEET C • AGES 14–17 • 35–45 MINUTES

# Teens: Decisions without easy answers

**Purpose:** Learn to recognize real-world constraints and ask what practical options are missing. The fictional situations are for analysis ... **not role-play**.

## Read one fictional situation per small group (10 minutes)

**SITUATION 1 • Work hours**

A retail worker ends an evening shift after a shelter's latest admission time. The worker has income but cannot find a room within budget.

**SITUATION 2 • Keeping family together**

A parent is offered a temporary arrangement that cannot accommodate their child or meet the family's transportation needs.

**SITUATION 3 • School stability**

A student is staying temporarily with relatives. The commute and uncertainty make attendance and homework harder.

**SITUATION 4 • Belongings and documents**

An adult has no safe storage for work clothes, identification, or medication and must travel to appointments across town.

## Questions (20 minutes)

- Which needs are immediate? Which problems are caused by a missing resource rather than a poor personal decision?
- What options does the person realistically have? What key information is missing?
- What would make this situation easier ... housing, schedule flexibility, safe storage, transit, services, or something else?

## Write one specific improvement for Chico (10 minutes)

**Facilitator rule:** The goal is to notice limited choices, not ask teenagers to guess what homelessness "feels like" or rank who deserves help.

SHEET D • ADULTS / MIXED GROUPS • 45 MINUTES

# Adults: Three perspectives, one community

**Purpose:** Practice listening without requiring agreement on every policy.

## Read three viewpoints, then discuss

**Neighbor:** “I’m worried about safety, trash, and how usable our neighborhood parks feel.”
**Person without housing:** “I need somewhere safe to sleep and keep my things ... and I don’t always have a realistic alternative.”
**Service provider:** “We want to help, but programs have limits and we cannot promise a housing placement to everyone right away.”

**1. What does each person want?** Avoid telling them what they “really” mean. (10 minutes)

**2. Identify two shared goals.** (10 minutes)

**3. List two questions that need facts, not assumptions.** (10 minutes)

**4. Identify one respectful next step.** (10 minutes)

**Facilitator:** Acknowledge distinct perspectives, but do not require participants to agree with a harmful generalization or abandon their own experience.

SHEET E • AGES 11+ • 15–20 MINUTES

# Optional: Listening and language exercise

**Purpose:** Notice the difference between a fact, an assumption, and a respectful question.

Discuss each sentence. What is observed? What is assumed? How might the speaker ask a better question?

| Statement | Observed fact or interpretation? | Better question to ask |
|---|---|---|
| “Everyone on the street refuses help.” | | |
| “Moving tents means fewer people are homeless.” | | |
| “People in shelters have no problems.” | | |
| “Our neighborhood feels less safe.” | | |

**Debrief:** What words could help us talk about a difficult community issue while still recognizing the dignity of all neighbors?

SHEET F • ANY AGE (ADAPT AS NEEDED)

# Reflection: What changed for you?

Complete individually, with a partner, or as a closing circle. Sharing is optional.

## One thing I learned today ...

## One assumption I want to reconsider ...

## One question I still have ...

## One way I could treat a neighbor with more dignity ...

**For overnight participants:** What could you stop doing tomorrow that someone without a safe home cannot simply stop? (Keep the focus on differences, not equivalence.)

**End with this:** “Our night was temporary. What we learned can stay with us.”

# Optional videos for older groups

These are optional companions to the six activity sheets; no video is required to take part. A facilitator should preview the full recording before selecting an excerpt. These titles link to the publishers.

### Can You Tell Who is HOMELESS? — OrgCode

**Why show it:** A conversation starter about the assumptions we make from clothing, appearance, and first impressions.

**Watch on OrgCode (the title and link are clickable in the PDF)**

### Why PERSON-FIRST Language is Important. — OrgCode

**Why show it:** Introduces the idea of describing someone as a person rather than reducing them to a housing status.

**Watch on OrgCode (the title and link are clickable in the PDF)**

### Why So Many Teens Are Becoming Homeless — OrgCode

**Why show it:** Explores why young people may lose stable housing and what support they need to stay safe.

**Watch on OrgCode (the title and link are clickable in the PDF)**

### The Reality of Family Homelessness — OrgCode

**Why show it:** Introduces the forms of family homelessness that can be less visible than sleeping outdoors.

**Watch on OrgCode (the title and link are clickable in the PDF)**

### The Missing Piece in Ending Homelessness: Shared Values — OrgCode

**Why show it:** Opens discussion about shared community values among people who disagree about homelessness policy.

**Watch on OrgCode (the title and link are clickable in the PDF)**

### Homeless ENCAMPMENT Response 101 — OrgCode

**Why show it:** Introduces approaches and outcome measures for community responses to outdoor encampments.

**Watch on OrgCode (the title and link are clickable in the PDF)**

Ages 6–10: use the drawing and discussion activities without a required video. Ages 11–13: preview material carefully. For teens and adults: offer a chance to opt out and do not ask anyone to share their own housing situation.